

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

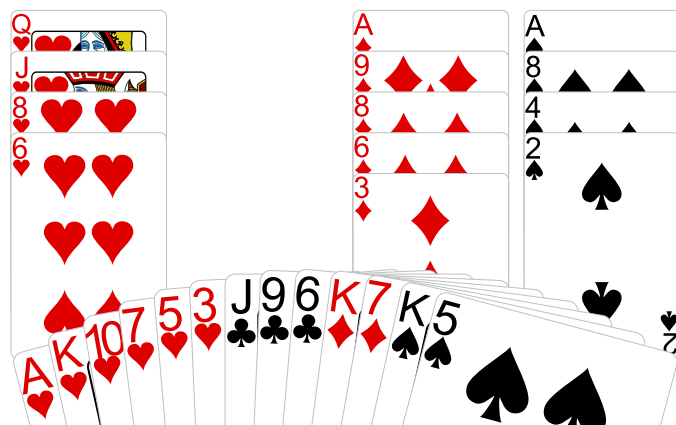
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 7♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



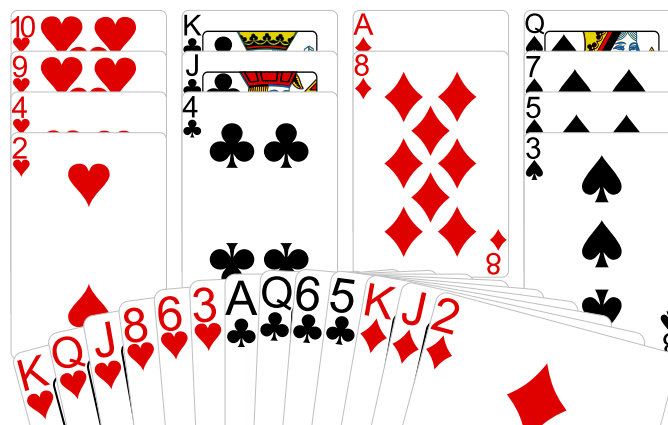
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7♥

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: West

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 7 6
♥ 9 4
♦ J T 4
♣ A Q 8 7 4

14
7 8
11

♠ K 5
♥ A K T 7 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ J 9 6

N
W E
S

♠ A 8 4 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 9 8 6 3
♣ -

♠ Q J 9 3
♥ 2
♦ Q 5 2
♣ K T 5 3 2

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5NT
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			
7♥ by North			

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SOUTH's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card

♥

support,

at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

NORTH bids 4NT, Blackwood.

SOUTH's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

NORTH counts thirteen tricks and bids 7

♥

.

Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ -
♥ A 9 7 5
♦ K 9 8 6 4
♣ J 9 3 2

7
8 18
7

♠ A Q J 9 8 4
♥ 6
♦ T 7 2
♣ 8 7 5

N
W E
S

♠ T 7 6 2
♥ 8 4 2
♦ Q J 5 3
♣ A 4

♠ K 5 3
♥ K Q J T 3
♦ A
♣ K Q T 6

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by East			

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EAST figures that if WEST holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

WEST only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which

is higher-ranking than

♥

s.

EAST manages to figure out that WEST has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.

Deal 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J T 2
♥ 9 5 4 3 2
♦ K Q J
♣ 5 2

8
7 8
17

♠ K 7 5 3

♥ J 8 7

♦ A 8 6 5

♣ 7 4



♠ A 9 8 6 4

♥ A K Q

♦ 7

♣ K J 6 3

♠ Q
♥ T 6
♦ T 9 4 3 2
♣ A Q T 9 8

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SOUTH may have a good hand but NORTH merely gave a simple raise.

Even if NORTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Deal 4

West Deals
Both Vul

♠ -
♥ K Q J 8 6 3
♦ K J 2
♣ A Q 6 5

8
16 10
6

♠ A T 9 6
♥ A 7
♦ T 9 7 3
♣ T 3 2



♠ K J 8 4 2
♥ 5
♦ Q 6 5 4
♣ 9 8 7

♠ Q 7 5 3
♥ T 9 4 2
♦ A 8
♣ K J 4

West
1 ♥
4 ♣
6 ♥
All Pass

North
Pass
Pass

East
3 ♥
4 ♦

South
Pass
Pass

6 ♥ by West
, hoping that he can at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!

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WEST has a tough decision after the two Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and EAST shows two Aces he will be no better off, because he won't know if one

of the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on knowing that EAST holds the

♦

A,
he bids 6

♥